

INVENTORY · STACK · STRUCTURE

# principles

Declared statements — short stated principles, each with a one-line justification.

## How we make calls when the spec is silent.

**Default to the cheaper-to-reverse choice.** Reversible calls don't need a meeting; only the irreversible ones do.

**Name the actor, never the system.** "The PM decides" lands; "the process decides" hides accountability.

**Write down the bet on the same slide as the choice.** The decision and its predicted outcome live together — the calibration loop depends on it.

**Form follows function.** Let the audience's need shape the layout, not the other way around.

**One main idea per slide.** If you can't summarise it in one sentence, split it across two slides.

## How we resolve conflicts — top wins.

**01** Default to the choice that is cheaper to reverse.

**02** Name the actor, never the system.

**03** Write down the bet on the same slide as the choice.

**04** Form follows function.

**05** One main idea per slide.

## When NOT to reach for principles.

**Aspirations, not principles.** "Be empathetic" is a value, not a principle. Principles are decision rules — they say what to do when two options conflict. Reach for content if it's a values statement.

**Long per-principle prose.** Each justification is one sentence. If a principle needs a paragraph of context, give it its own slide and let principles act as the index.

**Hedged statements.** "We try to default to X" reads as a wish. Drop the hedge — principles are declared, not negotiated. "Default to X" lands harder.

# See also.

## *RELATED COMPONENTS*

- `actors` — rules attach to named owners, not shared tenets
- `tldr` — single-line takeaways without justification body
- `list` — items are short bullets without title + body shape
- `cards-stack` — each principle needs two sentences of body